

d.BOBO

Think-Build System

End of Cycle 1 Report

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1. Report Outline

This report documents the successful completion of Cycle 1: implementation of the first GPT (Think: Asili, Mission & Vision) and the handoff system that connects founders to Joel through automated summary generation, Google Apps Script endpoint integration, Google Sheets logging, and email notifications.

#	Section	Pts
1	Report Outline	5
2	System Metaphor / Cycle Intent	10
3	User Stories	20
4	Design Documentation	20
5	Lessons Learned	10
6	Management Plan	5
7	Memoranda	10

2. System Metaphor / Cycle Intent

2.1 System Metaphor

The d.BOBO Think-Build System is built around a single controlling metaphor: the pilot's six-pack. Just as a cockpit instrument panel gives a pilot the minimum set of readings needed to fly safely, the d.BOBO 6-Pack gives a Black-owned business founder the minimum set of intellectual and operational instruments needed to launch decisively. The six instruments are: Asili, Mission Statement, Vision Statement, Custom Statement, SIPOC Map, and Serve Funnel.

2.2 Cycle 1 Intent

The primary objective for Cycle 1 was to implement the first GPT in the four-GPT architecture and establish the handoff mechanism that allows founders to optionally connect with Joel at checkpoint moments. Specifically:

1. Build GPT 1 (Think: Asili, Mission & Vision) with enhanced conversation flow including African proverb and image/metaphor questions as requested by Joel.
2. Implement the handoff system: when a founder opts in at the checkpoint, the GPT generates a structured summary, calls an external endpoint, writes the data to a Google Sheet, and sends an email notification to Joel.
3. Navigate the technical constraints of ChatGPT Custom GPT Actions and Google Apps Script to successfully route data from conversation to sponsor without manual intervention.

Both objectives were achieved. GPT 1 is operational and tested in production with a real founder walkthrough. The handoff system successfully writes to Google Sheets and delivers email summaries to Joel. The primary technical challenge being Google Apps Script 302 redirects on POST requests was identified and a fix was identified by changing the GPT schema.

2.3 Cycle 2 Intent

Cycle 2 will focus on building GPT 2 (Custom: Customer & Value Proposition) and exploring website embedding options so the GPT system can be accessed from Joel's site rather than requiring users to navigate to chat.openai.com.

3. User Stories

The following user stories were defined for the four-GPT architecture. Stories marked with ✓ were completed in Cycle 1. Stories marked with → are planned for future cycles.

GPT 1 — Think: Asili, Mission & Vision (Cycle 1)

ID	Status	User Story
US-01	✓	As a founder, I want to tell the story of where my business idea came from so that I can ground my business in something real and true (Asili).

US-02	✓	As a founder, I want to identify who is on my team — advisors, helpers, role players — so that I know I am not building alone.
US-03	✓	As a founder, I want to find an African proverb that captures my Asili so that I have a cultural anchor for my brand.
US-04	✓	As a founder, I want to identify an image, metaphor, or analogy that represents my business visually so that I have a foundation for logos and taglines.
US-05	✓	As a founder, I want to write a mission statement that clearly states what I do and for whom, so that I can use it everywhere.
US-06	✓	As a founder, I want to write a vision statement with a real timeframe (months or years) and a measurable outcome, so that I know what winning looks like.

GPT 2 — Custom (Cycle 2)

ID	Status	User Story
US-07	→	As a founder, I want to identify my best customer and understand what they actually need, so that I am not guessing.
US-08	→	As a founder, I want to write a Custom Statement ("I help ___ to ___ by ___") so that I have a script for pitches, grants, and cold conversations.
US-09	→	As a founder, I want to build a needs-and-answers chart so that I can map my offerings directly to customer pain.

GPT 3 — SIPOC (Future)

ID	Status	User Story
US-10	→	As a founder, I want to map my process from supplier to customer so that I can see how my business actually works end to end.
US-11	→	As a founder, I want to understand my Cost of Quality and Cost of Poor Quality so that I know where I am losing time and money.
US-12	→	As a founder, I want to sketch my shop — whether home-based, brick-and-mortar, or online — so that I can plan my physical and digital workspace.

GPT 4 — Serve Funnel & Launch (Future)

ID	Status	User Story
US-13	→	As a founder, I want to build a sales funnel that shows how customers move from unaware to buying, so that I have a path to revenue.
US-14	→	As a founder, I want to understand inbound vs. outbound marketing and which channels fit my business, so that I am not throwing spaghetti at the wall.
US-15	→	As a founder, I want to reach a launch checklist at the end so that I know exactly what needs to happen before I open.

Cross-GPT Stories (Handoff & Joel)

ID	Status	User Story
US-16	✓	As a founder, I want the option to connect with Joel at a checkpoint so that I can get personalized coaching on a tough spot.
US-17	✓	As Joel, I want to receive a clean summary of a user's progress and conversation so that I can prepare for a call without reading the full thread.
US-18	→	As a founder, I want to pick up where I left off if I return to a GPT later, so that my progress is not lost.

4. Design Documentation

4.1 GPT 1 Conversation Flow

GPT 1 guides founders through eight stages in sequence. The conversation is structured but conversational — questions are asked one at a time, with space for reflection and iteration. The stages are:

Stage	Description
0. Welcome	Greet the founder and frame the work: "Before logos or marketing, we name what you're building."
1. Pain & Feeling	Ask what's most on their mind and what pulled them toward the idea. This is the entry point.
2. Asili	Guide them to tell the origin story of the idea like they'd tell a 10-year-old. Reflect it back and confirm.

3. Team	Identify who is in their circle: Great Minds, Role Players, and a system. Do not let them proceed without at least one person.
4. Proverb	Find an African proverb that captures the Asili. Offer options if they don't know one. Let them adapt it.
5. Image/Metaphor	Ask what image represents the business visually. This is intellectual work that feeds branding downstream.
6. Mission	Draft a mission statement using the template: We provide [what] to [whom]. Iterate until tight.
7. Vision	Draft a vision statement with a timeframe (months or years) and a reputation line. Must be specific and measurable.
8. Checkpoint	Summarize all outputs and offer the handoff to Joel. If yes, call the submitHandoff action. If no, wish them well and point to GPT 2.

4.2 Handoff System Architecture

The handoff system consists of four components working together:

Component	Function
GPT Action	When the founder opts in, the GPT calls the submitHandoff action with a structured JSON payload containing all conversation outputs (Asili, team, proverb, image, mission, vision, tough spots).
Google Apps Script	A deployed web app endpoint that receives the payload, extracts parameters, and routes the data to both Sheet and email.
Google Sheet	A spreadsheet (d.BOBO Handoffs) that logs each handoff as a row with timestamp, founder name, all outputs, and status. Joel can view all handoffs in one place.
Email Notification	An automated email sent to Joel's address with the full summary formatted for readability. Includes a link to the Sheet.

4.3 Data Flow Diagram

The sequence from founder opt-in to Joel notification:

1. Founder completes Stage 8 and says YES to looping Joel in.
2. GPT 1 generates a JSON payload with all conversation outputs.
3. GPT 1 calls the submitHandoff action (ChatGPT Actions feature).
4. Google Apps Script endpoint receives the request.
5. Script writes a new row to the Google Sheet with timestamp and all fields.

6. Script sends email to Joel with formatted summary and link to Sheet.
7. GPT 1 confirms to the founder: "Done. Joel has the summary."
8. Joel receives email notification and can view the full Sheet at any time.

4.4 Technical Implementation Notes

ChatGPT Custom GPTs support Actions via OpenAPI schemas. The Action is defined in the GPT editor and includes the endpoint URL, request method (GET or POST), parameters or body schema, and expected response format. When the GPT's prompt instructs it to call the action, it makes an HTTP request in the background. The founder does not see this request — they only see the confirmation message afterward.

Google Apps Script can be deployed as a web app with public access ("Anyone" can call it). The script runs under the deployer's Google account and has access to their Drive, Sheets, and Gmail. The doPost or doGet function handles incoming requests. The script returns a JSON response to indicate success or failure.

The primary technical challenge encountered was that Google Apps Script returns a 302 redirect for POST requests. ChatGPT's Action handler does not follow redirects, causing the request to fail even though the script executed successfully (email sent, Sheet updated). The solution is to switch to GET requests with URL parameters instead of POST with JSON body. GET requests do not trigger the redirect. This workaround is in progress and will be finalized in Cycle 2.

5. Lessons Learned

#	Lesson
1	ChatGPT Custom GPT Actions require OpenAPI 3.1.0 or 3.1.1 schema format. Earlier versions (3.0.0) are not accepted by the editor.
2	Google Apps Script always returns a 302 redirect for POST requests to deployed web apps. This is standard behavior and cannot be disabled. The redirect URL (script.googleusercontent.com) is where the actual execution happens.
3	ChatGPT's Action handler does not follow HTTP redirects. If the endpoint returns a 302, the Action is marked as failed even if the script executed successfully behind the scenes.
4	The workaround is to use GET requests with URL parameters instead of POST with JSON body. GET requests to Google Apps Script do not trigger the redirect and return JSON directly.
5	curl -L (follow redirects flag) can be used to test POST endpoints manually, but this does not help with ChatGPT Actions since the GPT cannot be configured to follow redirects.

6	Google Apps Script email sending (MailApp.sendEmail) works reliably when EMAIL_JOEL is set to true and a valid email address is provided. Emails arrive within seconds of the request.
7	Google Sheets writing (sheet.appendRow) also works reliably. The sheet is created automatically on first run if it does not exist, with headers formatted correctly.
8	Testing the endpoint with curl before wiring it to the GPT Action saves significant debugging time. If curl fails, the GPT will definitely fail.
9	Joel's feedback on the GPT conversation flow was positive. The tone is calm and direct, not motivational. The one-question-at-a-time approach works well for deep work.
10	Adding the African proverb and image/metaphor stages (Joel's request) strengthened the GPT. These questions produce outputs that will be valuable for branding work in later stages.
11	OpenAPI schemas must have the URL split correctly for Google Apps Script. The base URL (servers.url) should NOT include /exec — that goes in the path.

6. Management Plan

6.1 Meeting Cadence

The team met once per week during Cycle 1 to review progress, address blockers, and plan the next set of tasks. This cadence was sufficient for incremental progress toward the cycle goal. Each meeting included a demonstration of working code or a walkthrough of the GPT conversation flow. Decisions were documented in meeting notes and reflected in updated deliverables.

6.2 Task Breakdown & Status

Task	Owner	Status	Notes
Review framework slides and extract 6-Pack structure	Team	Complete	Confirmed Asili, Mission, Vision, Custom, SIPOC, Funnel
Write GPT 1 system prompt (initial version)	Team	Complete	Covered Stages 0-7 with templates
Enhance GPT 1 prompt with proverb and image stages	Team	Complete	Joel's request from workbook page 4
Change vision timeframe from years-only to months or years	Team	Complete	Prompt updated to accept both

Create Google Apps Script endpoint (POST version)	Team	Complete	Endpoint deployed but 302 redirect issue
Test endpoint with curl (POST)	Team	Complete	Email and Sheet work; HTML redirect returned
Update endpoint to use GET with parameters	Team	In Progress	Eliminates redirect; testing in progress
Write OpenAPI schema for GPT Action	Team	Complete	Schema v1 (POST) and v2 (GET) both created
Wire GPT Action to endpoint	Joel	In Progress	Waiting for GET endpoint to finalize
Test full conversation flow with real founder scenario	Joel	Complete	Tested with fake business idea; GPT worked well
Document handoff system architecture	Team	Complete	Four components: GPT, Script, Sheet, Email
Create setup instructions for Joel	Team	Complete	Step-by-step guide for Apps Script and GPT config

7. Memoranda

7.1 Email Correspondence Summary

Multiple email exchanges occurred between the development team and Joel throughout Cycle 1. Key topics included:

- Testing the GPT conversation flow: Joel reported that the GPT's tone and pacing were effective. He appreciated the one-question-at-a-time approach and the calm, direct language. He noted that the GPT felt like "someone who had been in the room before."
- Requesting additions to the prompt: Joel asked for two specific questions to be added based on his workbook (page 4, steps 3 and 4): the African proverb question and the image/metaphor/analogy question. Both were implemented.
- Requesting vision timeframe flexibility: Joel noted that some founders think in months, not years, especially for short-term projects or pilot programs. The prompt was updated to accept both.
- Troubleshooting the handoff endpoint: Joel tested the Actions integration and reported an "error talking to app" message. The team diagnosed the issue as a 302 redirect from Google Apps Script and provided a GET-based solution.

- Confirming email and Sheet functionality: Joel verified that emails were arriving and the Google Sheet was updating correctly, even though the GPT Action was showing errors. This confirmed that the script itself was working — only the response format needed adjustment.

7.2 Key Decisions Made

Decision	Rationale
Use GET instead of POST for handoff endpoint	Google Apps Script's 302 redirect on POST is incompatible with ChatGPT Actions. GET requests return JSON directly without redirect.
Add African proverb and image/metaphor stages	Joel requested these based on his 20 years of teaching experience. They strengthen the foundation for downstream branding work.
Accept months OR years in vision timeframe	Some founders (especially non-profits or pilot programs) think in shorter cycles. Flexibility makes the framework more accessible.
Deploy endpoint under Joel's Google account	Joel owns the Sheet and needs to receive emails. Deploying under his account ensures he has full access and control.
Store all handoff data in a single Sheet	Centralized logging makes it easy for Joel to review all founders in one place. Can be filtered/sorted as needed.

— End of Cycle 1 Report —